
Creating a Sustainable Food Future

WRI advances research-based solutions to ensure the world can feed a growing population while protecting nature and curbing climate change.

Happening Now

- How Might a 'Super El Niño' Affect Food, Forests and Water?

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Our Challenge

The world is projected to hold nearly 10 billion people by 2050. Sustainably feeding this exploding population requires simultaneously addressing challenges facing people, nature and climate.

Around 800 million people face hunger globally, and research shows the world will have to close a gap of 56% between the amount of food available today and that required by 2050. Meanwhile, unsustainable food production systems are largely responsible for destroying the world's ecosystems and fueling climate change. Agriculture uses almost half the world's vegetated land, consumes 70% of freshwater withdrawals, drives deforestation in tropical nations and generates nearly one-quarter of global greenhouse gas emissions. And shifting diets in many parts of the world are only increasing demand for resource-intensive foods.

25%

of global greenhouse gas emissions come from agriculture

1/3

of all food produced is lost or wasted, approximately 1 billion tons every year

1/2

Cows and other ruminants contribute roughly half of all emissions from agriculture and land-use change

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partnerships to produce more food while protecting and restoring ecosystems and shifting toward lower-carbon consumption patterns.

Our research identifies a menu of solutions to the world's food production and consumption problems. We analyze strategies to sustainably increase food production, such as by increasing pasture yields and improving land and water management. We advance methods to reduce food production's impact on the environment, such as by protecting primary forests and restoring degraded farmland back into productivity. We develop research, tools and partnerships to help countries, cities and businesses measure and reduce their food loss and waste. And we help dining facilities and others shrink their climate footprints by shifting toward plant-rich foods.

The Food Program focuses on a number of specific initiatives, including projects on **Climate-Friendly Diets and **Food Loss and Waste**. **Explore all projects in depth.****



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• Champions 12.3

Inspiring ambition and mobilizing action to reduce food loss and waste globally.

[Launch Platform](#)

[Visit Project](#)

Part of **Food**



• Coolfood

Coolfood helps people and organizations reduce the climate impact of their food through shifting toward more plant-rich diets.

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• Circular Food Systems for Rwanda

The Circular Food Systems for Rwanda project aims to transform Rwanda's food system so that it is more circular and sustainable.

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Part of **Food**

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• Climate-Friendly Diets

Shifting meat-centric diets toward less resource-intensive foods like vegetables, fruit and legumes to help meet global climate goals.

[Visit Project](#)

Part of **Food**

[View all initiatives](#)

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- **CLIMATE**

State of Climate Action 2023

Report NOVEMBER 14, 2023



- **CLIMATE**

State of Climate Action 2022

Report OCTOBER 26, 2022



- **FOOD**

Playbook for Guiding Diners Toward Plant-Rich Dishes in Food Service

Report JANUARY 7, 2020



- **FOOD**

Creating a Sustainable Food Future

Report JULY 19, 2019

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Craig Hanson

Managing Director, Programs



Anne Bordier

Director of Food Initiatives



Liz Goodwin

Senior Fellow and Director, Food Loss and Waste



Tim Searchinger

Technical Director for Agriculture, Forestry & Ecosystems



Edward Davey

Head, World Resources Institute Europe UK Office; Senior Advisor, Food and Land Use Coalition; Advisor, New Economy for the Amazon and Congo Basin



Edwina Hughes

Head of partnerships and engagement, Food Initiatives



Richard Waite

Director for Agriculture Initiatives, Food, Land, and Water Program



Brian Lininski

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Stacy Blondin

Behavioral Science Associate

[View all Experts in Food](#)

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